

Structure. What structure?

If you work in the comfort of your own house or a communal work space or the local coffee shop, chances are structure isn't going to be a part of the ballgame. You do not have fixed working hours. You don't need to get to the cafe at 10 am sharp. This would mean you need bucketloads of self motivation to ensure that you are sticking to deadlines and not letting procrastination get the better of you.

It's difficult to create schedules and stick to them (unless, of course, you're Sheldon Cooper). For the average joe, it's difficult to stick to self created deadlines especially when you don't have a boss breathing down your neck. It's pretty easy to lose track of time or focus on jobs that are seemingly easy but not as pressing.

Clients usually hire freelancers when they lack the in-house resources for a certain job. This would also mean that for the duration of the project or work that you have undertaken, you might have to be available on call or emails at most points in time during the working hours of your client. They may need your expertise if they are stuck, and being unavailable to lead them out of this crisis could mean losing out on a chance to work with them the next time around.

I bit off more than I could chew:

Ever tried putting a whole donut into your mouth? It's fun to do but not the easiest thing to chew through. That being said, it is pretty easy to do the same thing as a freelancer. Since your payments are unpredictable as are your working hours, it's pretty commonplace to take on more work than you can deal with.

You could take on the extra work because of multiple reasons -

- The Money - Every extra penny helps. The limited salary was one of the primary reasons you quit your corporate job.
- The Client - You could be worried about losing out on the client in question. If you refuse to take up this current offer citing time issues, the client may not want to work with you in the future.
- Incorrect Estimations - You think you can finish the backlog you have in 3 days and then move onto the new work which has a deadline 2 weeks from now.

What you fail to consider is that work done for an existing client may come back for design changes or re-edits. Your work isn't absolute, ever! So you might eventually be promising more than you can deliver. If this is a